

Build a complete move habit

Foundations

THE IDEA

A reliable move habit combines an opponent check, candidate selection, calculation, and a final blunder scan. The sequence should be short enough to use during real games. Its purpose is to prevent predictable errors, not to make every move slow.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Before playing a planned rook lift, notice whether the opponent's last pawn move attacked your bishop. After calculating the lift, visualize its final square and check whether an enemy knight can capture it.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should your final scan examine?

ANSWER AND REASONING

The exact position after your move: checks against your king, captures of valuable pieces, and forcing threats. Looking only at the current board misses dangers created by your move.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Before releasing a move, let the opponent answer it in your head.